

01 SMALL TALK

How was your weekend? Did anything fun happen?

Do you like cake and sweet things, or are you more of a savory person?

When is your birthday? Is it coming up soon?

02 POP QUIZ — DOES THIS SOUND NATURAL?

1 ~~"He gave me a big impression."~~

✓ "He made a strong impression on me."

'make an impression on someone'이 고정 표현이에요. give는 안 쓰고 big보다 strong이 자연스러워요.

2 ~~"We meeting for 3 months."~~

✓ "We've been seeing each other for 3 months."

be동사가 빠졌어요. 연애 맥락에선 meet보다 'see each other'나 'date'를 써요.

3 ~~"I have a some."~~

✓ "I'm kind of seeing someone."

한국어 '썸'을 some이라고 하면 안 통해요. 'kind of seeing someone'이 그 느낌이에요.

03 오늘의 워업

각자 1-4위로 순위 매기고 1위만 말하기. 다른 사람 의견 들으며 자기 순위 한 번 더 정리.

WARM-UP

Rank Them (5분)

1. A handwritten letter or card
2. A surprise gift
3. A nice dinner together
4. A short trip somewhere new

LOVE · MAIN DISCUSSION

Dating Anniversaries — Sweet Effort or Too Much Pressure?

BACKGROUND

기념일을 행하는 방식은 사랑의 표현이 될 수도 있고 부담의 시작이 될 수도 있어요. 100일, 1주년, 생일처럼 특별한 날을 중요하게 생각하는 사람들에게는 준비 자체가 애정 표현이에요. 반대로 매번 선물과 이벤트를 맞춰야 한다고 느끼면 관계가 숙제처럼 느껴질 수 있죠. 중요한 건 크기보다 합의예요. 서로에게 어떤 날이 의미 있고, 어느 정도의 표현이 편한지 미리 알면 기념일이 압박보다 즐거움에 가까워져요.

READ BEFORE WE TALK

Anniversaries can make a relationship feel cared for, but they can also create pressure if expectations are unclear. For some people, remembering dates and preparing small gestures is a natural way to show love. For others, too many celebrations feel like a test they might fail. The real issue is not whether anniversaries matter. It is how much meaning both people give them, and what kind of effort feels comfortable. A handwritten note, a dinner, a gift, or simply remembering the date can all mean different things. The happiest couples often talk about expectations before the special day turns into a surprise exam. Dating standards are rarely only about romance. They also show how people think about fairness, attention, money, and feeling safe with each other.

WORDS YOU MIGHT NEED

a deal-breaker — 절대 양보 못 하는 조건

make it up to someone — (실수를) 만회하다

keep it low-key — 소박하게/조용히 하다

set expectations — 기대치를 미리 맞추다

feel pressured — 부담을 느끼다

TRY THESE PHRASES

Honestly, anniversaries feel ___ to me — mostly because ___.

It depends on the year, but usually they feel ___.

I'd say it's ___ because ___.

The way I see it, forgetting once is ___, but ___.

EASY ENTRY

- 1 Are you more of a 'count-every-100-days' person or a 'just-celebrate-the-big-one' person when it comes to dating anniversaries?
- 2 What's your usual move when an anniversary is coming up — plan a secret surprise, or decide what to do together?
- 3 Quick — if you had to pick on an anniversary: post the photos online, keep them just for you two, or not take photos at all?
- 4 On a scale of 1 to 5, how early do you usually start planning for an anniversary date?

MAIN DISCUSSION

Q1. Do anniversaries feel sweet, important, or a little pressured to you?

↳ *Honestly, anniversaries feel ___ to me — mostly because ___.*

↳ *It depends on the year, but usually they feel ___.*

Q2. Is forgetting an anniversary a serious problem, or just a small mistake?

↳ *I'd say it's ___ because ___.*

↳ *The way I see it, forgetting once is ___, but ___.*

Q3. Do small gestures matter more than expensive gifts?

↳ *I lean more toward ___ because ___.*

↳ *Compared to expensive gifts, small gestures feel ___.*

Q4. Would you prefer a gift, a nice meal, a letter, or just time together — and why?

↳ *If I had to choose, I'd pick ___ because ___.*

↳ *What matters most to me is ___, so I'd go with ___.*

Q5. How can couples talk about expectations without ruining the mood?

↳ *What works for me is ___ — for example, ___.*

↳ *The thing is, you can ___ if you ___.*